HOUSEWIVES MEAL PREP MASTERCLASS

Weekly Family Meal Prep & Pantry Rotation

A complete operational guide for batch cooking, FIFO inventory control, and storage

1 Step 1: 7-Day Family Menu Architecture

Building a predictable weekly menu prevents impulse grocery spending and reduces daily mealtime stress. Successful meal planning balances high-labor fresh meals with quick batch-assembled items while maximizing component overlap across multiple dishes.

Component Overlap Principle

Prepare core ingredients that serve 2–3 distinct meals during the week. Cook a double portion of protein or grain and repurpose it into entirely different regional flavor profiles.

Perishability Sequencing

Schedule tender leafy greens, fish, and soft produce for Monday–Wednesday. Reserve heartier root vegetables, frozen proteins, and cruciferous veggies for Thursday–Sunday.

2 Standardized 7-Day Master Meal Schedule

Day	Dinner Theme	Primary Proteins & Grains	Prep Focus
Mon	Mediterranean Bowl	Roasted Chicken Breasts & Quinoa	Use fresh greens & tender cucumber
Tue	Taco / Fajita Night	Seasoned Ground Beef & Brown Rice	Chop peppers & fresh cilantro
Wed	Sheet Pan Sausage & Veg	Smoked Sausage & Sweet Potatoes	Utilize pre-batched root veggies
Thu	Curry / Stir-Fry	Chicken Breast (repurposed) & Rice	Thaw frozen broccoli & peas
Fri	Homemade Flatbreads	Leftover Beef, Mozzarella, Marinara	Clear out remaining perishable odds
Sat	Slow Cooker Stew	Beef Chuck & Carrots / Potatoes	Low-effort batch simmer

Pro-Tip: Theme Days Reduce Decision Fatigue

Assigning consistent weekly themes (e.g., Taco Tuesday, Sheet-Pan Thursday) limits the decisions you make each week while keeping variety high through rotating spices and sauces.

3 Step 2: Pantry Inventory & FIFO Management

The **First-In, First-Out (FIFO)** system guarantees that older stock is consumed before newly purchased items, reducing food waste and grocery expenditure.

Pantry Shelf Organization Zone

- **Top Shelf:** Backups, bulk grains, and overstock unopened items.
- **Eye Level:** Everyday staples, opened snacks, and current week ingredients.
- **Bottom Shelf:** Heavy cans, oils, sauces, and heavy root vegetables.

The 3-Zone FIFO Workflow

- **Step 1:** Unload groceries and push older items to the front.
- **Step 2:** Place new items directly behind existing inventory.
- **Step 3:** Label open items with the opening date on masking tape.

4 Step 3 & 4: Batch Chop & Container Protocols

Efficient prep requires treating vegetable cutting and meal assembly like an industrial line. Group similar tasks together rather than prepping meal-by-meal.

Vegetable Category	Prep Method	Storage Container Type	Max Shelf Life
Hard Roots (Carrots, Beets)	Diced or sticks submerged in water	Glass jar with sealed lid	7–10 Days
Cruciferous (Broccoli, Cauliflower)	Floret chops, dry thoroughly	Airtight container + paper towel	5–7 Days
Aromatics (Onions, Garlic)	Fine dice or mince	Sealed glass container (odor control)	4–5 Days
Leafy Greens (Spinach, Kale)	Wash, spin-dry completely	Ventilated container with dry towel	3–5 Days
Soft Veggies (Zucchini, Peppers)	Sliced or diced, keep dry	Airtight silicone or plastic bin	3–4 Days

Standard Container Labeling Formula

`[ ITEM NAME ] | [ PREP DATE ] | [ USE BY DATE ]`

Example: "Chop Bell Peppers | Prep: Oct 22 | Use By: Oct 26"

Use painter's masking tape and a water-resistant marker on all containers to keep tracking simple and clean during weekly turnarounds.